



Nurturing talent: Puneri Paltan had a squad stacked with all-rounders. If an Aslam (L) was sent to the bench, in came a Mohit Goyat (R) or a Pankaj Mohite or an Akash Shinde — all academy exports. PKL MEDIA

worldwide over the last three decades, underlines the tournament's role in galvanising ecosystems besides that of India. "This is what we have to learn

from judo and taekwondo. These sports originated in Japan and the nation sent coaches outside to spread the gospel of these sports. The Indian government should do the same," he tells *Sportstar*. "See what the Odisha government has done with hockey. Kabaddi doesn't need so much if we get the same thing done with it. If — like Japan — we adopt the sport as a culture rather than sport, imagine what it can do for

the sport. Taekwondo is in the Olympics today."

Goswami believes the elected federations and synergy between the league and these entities will go a long way in moving towards these objectives. Elections to the Amateur Kabaddi Federation of India (AKFI) were held late last year but coordinated efforts to galvanise the sport's administration are yet to take shape.